Solutions and teaching notes, chapter 7

Teacher use. The following answers concern the tasks not solved in the lesson. Do first make the approach explicit; provide graduated help before the solution. The durations are estimates to be calibrated in class.

Diagnostic and remediation

1. 0. *Action:* Go back to the orthogonality criterion.

2. Yes: $2 \quad -2=0$. *Action:* Substitute x and y simultaneously.

3. $x=3,\ y=2$. *Action:* Add, then substitute.

4. 5. *Action:* Calculate the vector and then its norm.

5. $(x-2)^2-4$. *Action:* Expand to check.

6. The only pair (0; 0). *Action:* Use the sum of two positive squares.

Investigation

Trials suggest H(2;4), but Pythagoras' theorem in PHM proves minimality. The projection is calculated with the normal (2;-1).

Direct applications

1. $3(x-2)+4(y+1)=0$, i.e. $3 \quad x+4y-2=0$.

2. $H(2;\ 1)$ and distance 2; the normal is horizontal.

3. $(x+1)^2+(y-4)^2=0$: the single point $(\ -1;\ 4)$, not a circle of strictly positive radius.

4. $(x-1)^2=0$, so only the point (1; 1); the line is tangent to the circle.

Exercises: methods and answers

Exercise 7.1 · Constructing a line. $2(x+1)+5(y-3)=0$, i.e. $2 \quad x+5y-13=0$. Direction vector $(5;-2)$, therefore $B(4;\ 1)$ is on the line; check $8+5 \quad -13=0$.

Exercise 7.2 · Calculating a projection. Normal vector $(2;\ -1)$; $\lambda=\dfrac{8-3}{5}=1$. $H=(4;3)-(2;-1)=(2;4)$. $2(2)-4=0$ and $\overrightarrow{PH}=(-2;\ 1)$ is a normal vector; distance $\sqrt{5}$.

Exercise 7.3 · Recognising a circle. $(x-3)^2+(y+2)^2=25$; centre $(3; \quad -2)$, radius 5. For $y=-2,\ x=3\pm5$: $(-2;-2)$ and $(8;-2)$.

Exercise 7.4 · Perpendicular bisector. Midpoint I(1;2), normal $\overrightarrow{AB}=(4;2)$. $4(x-1)+2(y-2)=0$, i.e. $2x+y-4=0$. I satisfies $2+2 \quad -4=0$.

Exercise 7.5 · The best access. The projection H(2;4) minimises PH, with length $\sqrt{5}$ km. For every M on the road, triangle PHM is right-angled at H and $PM^2=PH^2+HM^2\geq PH^2$. Equality for M=H.

Exercise 7.6 · Parameter and set. $(x-1)^2+(y+2)^2=5-k$. If $k<5$, circle with centre $(1;-2)$ and radius $\sqrt{5-k}$; if $k=5$, a point; if $k>5$, empty.

Exercise 7.7 · A parabola as a locus. $MF^2=x^2+(y-2)^2$, squared distance to the axis y^2. Equality: $x^2-4y+4=0$, or $y=\frac{x^2}{4}+1$. Positive distances allow the converse to be used.

Exercise 7.8 · Delayed review. Centre (2; 0), radius 2 ; ($x-2)^2+y^2=4$. For x=5, $y^2=-5$, impossible. Interpretation: the line is at distance 3 from the centre, greater than the radius.

CQFD, Exercise 18 p. 279, questions a, b, c and d. Possible answers are ($-1;2)$, $(3;-6)$, $(\frac{1}{4};-1)$ and (1; 0). Any nonzero multiple works. For $x=4$, write $x-4=0$.

CQFD, Exercise 21 p. 279, questions a and b. a : $x-(y-2)=0$, i.e. $x-y+2=0$. b : $4(x+1)+6(y-3)=0$, i.e. $2x+3y-7=0$. Substituting the coordinates of the points confirms membership.

MCQ: answers and reasons

MCQ 1.

1. B. Coefficients of x and y.

2. A. Zero product with the normal vector.

3. D. Read the coordinates with opposite signs.

4. C. Positive square root of 9.

5. B. A sum of squares is nonnegative.

MCQ 2.

1. C. Same x-coordinate, zero y-coordinate.

2. A. Absolute vertical distance.

3. D. Nonzero normal vector.

4. B. Both squares must be zero.

5. C. $y^2=0$.

True or false

1. True: through P there is a unique line perpendicular to the given line; if P lies on the line, H=P.

2. False: if c=0, a single point; if c>0, the empty set.

3. False: substituting a parametrisation of a line into the equation of a circle gives an equation quadratic with strictly positive leading coefficient, hence at most two roots.

Differentiated teaching. If a pupil is stuck on a technical point, suggest only the first step (domain, factor or reference sample space), then remove the help. For an independent student, ask for a second method and the handling of a boundary case. Orally, allow an initial rephrasing in the language mastered, then require a precise mathematical sentence in French.